MRNA

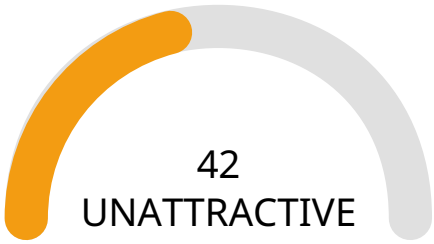
Moderna, Inc. (NASDAQ)

As-of: 17-Oct-2026 | Latest Filing: Q2 2026 (10-Q) | Currency: USD

$218.01 [Mkt 17-Oct-26]

Market Cap: $87.0B [Mkt 17-Oct-26]

Attractiveness Score



Confidence: **Medium** (0 pillars excluded)

Pillar Breakdown

1. Operating Quality — 55

Genuine mRNA platform moat with only BioNTech as a real peer, and a $6.9B cash fortress. But there is no recurring revenue engine: margins are -141%, ROIC deeply negative, and the business still burns billions a year.

2. Recent Trend — 40

Revenue collapsed three years straight: -64%, -53%, -40%. Q2 2026 stabilized at +2% but off a $145M quarterly base. The real trend is cost discipline: opex cut $2.2B (30%) in 2025. Losses are narrowing, not because the business is growing.

3. Forward Growth — 55

Credible but binary drivers: FDA-approved flu vaccine, mNEXSPIKE rollout, EU respiratory market opening 2027, Intismeran melanoma readout. Consensus only projects $3.39B revenue by 2028, 75% above 2025 but under half of 2023.

4. Valuation — 25

At $218, market pays 44x trailing sales and 24x consensus 2028 revenue. Our DCF base is $89.11 (-59% downside) and even the bull case $182.30 sits below the price. Reverse DCF implies 122% CAGR, pure perfection pricing. Consensus target $101 is -53% away.

5. Catalysts & Risk — 40

Real near-term catalysts: Intismeran Oct 24 presentation, Q3 earnings Nov 5, flu launch. But risk skew is sharply negative at a 52-week high after a

306% six-month run. $950M Arbutus payment, $2.6B convert dilution, and FDA refusal-to-file history add overhang.

Investment Thesis

- **Platform Rich, Business Poor:** Real mRNA moat, $6.9B cash [10-Q Q2 26], flu vaccine approved. But revenue fell from $19.3B (2022) to $1.94B (2025) [8-K FY25], and the business still loses ~$3B a year.
- **Binary Oncology Option:** Intismeran Phase III melanoma data on Oct 24, 2026 is the swing factor. The 306% six-month run has priced in success; a miss unwinds fast toward the $101 consensus target [Cons].
- **Price Denies the DCF:** At $218 [Mkt 17-Oct-26], the market implies 122% revenue CAGR. Our base case $89.11 means -59% downside, and the bull case $182.30 does not even reach the current price.

Key Operating Metrics

METRIC	LATEST	YOY CHANGE	3Y TREND
Revenue (FY2025)	$1.94B [8-K FY25]	-39.9% [8-K FY25]	Down
Revenue (Q2 2026)	$145M [10-Q Q2 26]	+2.1% [10-Q Q2 26]	Flat
Net Loss (FY2025)	-$2.82B [8-K FY25]	-$7.26/sh [8-K FY25]	Down
Cash & Investments (Jun 30, 2026)	$6.9B [10-Q Q2 26]	$4.7-5.2B guide yr-end [8-K guid]	Down
2026 Revenue Guide	up to +10% [8-K guid]	off $1.94B base [8-K guid]	Up
2028 Revenue Consensus	$3.39B [Cons]	+75% vs 2025 [Cons]	Up

Historical Financial Trend

METRIC	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25	TTM
Revenue	$19.26B [Cons]	$6.85B [Cons]	$3.24B [Cons]	$1.94B [8-K FY25]	$2.23B [Cons]
Net Loss	n/a [n/a]	n/a [n/a]	n/a [n/a]	-$2.82B [8-K FY25]	-$3.20B [Cons]
Cash & Investments	n/a [n/a]	n/a [n/a]	n/a [n/a]	$8.1B [8-K FY25]	$6.9B [10-Q Q2 26]

Valuation

Absolute (2/10)

P/S (trailing) 44x [Mkt 17-Oct-26]
P/B 9.7x [Mkt 17-Oct-26]
DCF Base $89.11, -59.1% downside [DCF]

The market prices 24x consensus 2028 revenue for a business still losing billions. Our DCF says the price is not even supported by the bull case ($182.30).

Versus Peers (3/8)

BNTX, NVAX surged too [Mkt 17-Oct-26]
Consensus target $101, Hold [Cons]

MRNA trades at the richest multiple among vaccine biotechs while 26 analysts rate it a Hold with targets 53% below the price.

Versus History (2/7)

$218 vs $22 Nov 2025 low [Mkt 17-Oct-26]
10x rally on no revenue growth

The entire move is multiple expansion on pipeline hope, not financials. Prior peaks collapsed 90%+.

Catalyst Timeline

24-Oct-2026 [8-K guid]
Intismeran Melanoma Data (Positive): Phase III interim readout with Merck; the single biggest swing factor for the pipeline premium.

05-Nov-2026 [Cons]
Q3 2026 Earnings (Two-Sided): Consensus -$1.10 EPS; U.S. vaccination rate and fall rollout color will matter more than the print.

2026 [8-K guid]
Flu Vaccine Launch (Positive): mRNA-1010 FDA

Top Risk Factors (Item 1A)

1. COVID Revenue Collapse: COVID revenue is in secular decline while the pipeline is years from meaningful revenue. Q2 product sales fell 18% YoY; U.S. vaccination rates are the key variable management cannot control. [10-Q Q2 26]

2. Regulatory Risk: The FDA issued a refusal-to-file letter for the mRNA-1010 flu application on trial-design grounds despite prior protocol discussions. Regulatory unpredictability is now a proven risk to the platform. [8-K FY25]

approved Sep 2026; first commercial season diversifies beyond COVID.

2026 [8-K guid]
Norovirus Phase III Readout (Two-Sided): Earlier interim missed early statistical criteria; additional cohort enrolled.

What Would Change Our Score

The Oct 24, 2026 Intismeran melanoma readout is the swing factor. A clean positive validates the oncology pipeline and the platform premium; a miss or statistical ambiguity unwinds the 306% rally toward the $101 consensus target and our $89.11 DCF base.

3. Legal Costs and Dilution: A $950M Arbutus/ Genevant litigation payment hit cash in July 2026, with ongoing royalties inflating cost of sales. The September $2.6B convertible adds 12.3M potential shares of dilution. [10-Q Q2 26]

Forward Growth Drivers

- Intismeran personalized cancer vaccine with Merck; Phase III melanoma interim in H2 2026 [8-K guid]
- Respiratory portfolio expansion: mNEXSPIKE rollout, FDA-approved flu vaccine, EU market opening 2027 [8-K guid]
- Cost discipline: 2025 operating expenses cut $2.2B (30%), 2026 GAAP opex guided to ~$4.7B ex litigation [8-K guid]

Missing / Modified Data Log

- Gross margin by product line not disclosed; cost of sales reported consolidated.
- Peer forward multiples (BNTX, NVAX) not verified from a current source; scored qualitatively.
- FY2022-24 cash balances and net loss figures not independently verified; revenue history verified via WallStreetZen annuals.

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